

Innovation Day 2026 FAQ

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General Questions

- **Q: Why should I sign up for a poster at Innovation Day?**
 - o Making a poster is a great way to showcase your accomplishments and share your work with the broader R&D community.
 - o It's also a great way to earn some recognition! We have several poster awards (with trophies). Ex: Best Overall Poster, Most Creative, Best Title.
- **Q: Am I required to make a poster?**
 - o No, you are not required, and participation is optional. However, we encourage anyone with work they'd like to highlight to participate. Innovation Day offers a unique opportunity to increase visibility for your work, connect with colleagues across R&D, and share your contributions with a broad audience.
- **Q: What kind of work or topic is appropriate for a poster?**
 - o We welcome a broad range of work from across R&D, including experiments, new methods, hardware, software, algorithms, workflow improvements, prototypes, data analysis, automation, internal services, and lessons learned from work in progress. Posters do not need to represent completed or published projects.
 - o This year, we would also like to place special emphasis on AI use cases across teams and disciplines. If your team is using AI, machine learning,

LLMs, or AI-assisted tools to solve a problem, accelerate a workflow, analyze data, support development, or explore a new way of working, please consider highlighting that work at Innovation Day. Where relevant, we also encourage authors to share how they approached prompting or otherwise worked with AI to achieve their results.

- **Q: Are AI-related projects encouraged this year?**
 - Yes. One focus for Innovation Day 2026 is showcasing how AI is being used across R&D. We encourage teams from every discipline to consider submitting AI use cases, whether AI is central to the project or simply one tool used to improve a process, generate insight, automate work, or accelerate development. Where applicable, presenters are also encouraged to share the prompts, techniques, or workflows they used so others can learn from their approach.

- **Q: I work with people in departments not invited to Innovation Day, can they attend?**
 - Participation in Innovation Poster Day is limited to members of the invited teams. We recognize that many of our projects involve close collaboration with colleagues across other groups and departments; however, due to venue and capacity limitations, attendance and poster presentation roles must be restricted to these teams (see next question for which teams these are).
 - Collaborators from other organizations are welcome to contribute content and may be acknowledged as co-authors or contributors on posters. However, they will not be eligible to present posters or attend Innovation Poster Day. We are not able to make exceptions, and those not invited will be turned away from the event.

- **Q: Which groups are invited to Innovation Day?**
 - Advanced Science, Sequencing Platforms, Systems Integration and Solutions, Bioinsight, and Experience Design.

- **Q: My group has already signed up for the maximum number of allocated posters. Can I still make a poster?**
 - The number of posters per group is a guideline to ensure representation of work across groups. It is not a quota, limit, or requirement. Please message Daniel Wright or Allie Duchnak with any related questions.

- **Q: I'm an author on multiple posters, can I have my posters placed close together so I can present at multiple posters?**
 - No, this year we will not be accommodating poster location requests. We encourage all poster authors to include multiple authors on each poster to ensure enough presenters.
- **Q: If I'm an author on a poster, do I automatically get signed up to receive an Innovation Day shirt?**
 - No. All poster authors must complete the shirt order form to receive a shirt.
- **Q: Can I sign up for an Innovation Day shirt if I'm not an author on a poster?**
 - Yes, anyone invited to Innovation Day can sign up to receive a shirt.
 - If you do not sign up for a shirt, you will not receive one.
- **Q: Does my project need to be finished?**
 - No. Work in progress, prototypes, experiments, lessons learned, and early findings are all appropriate.
- **Q: Can software, AI/ML, algorithm, or hardware projects be posters?**
 - Absolutely. Innovation Day is not limited to wet-lab work.
- **Q: How many presenters should each poster have?**
 - We recommend having 3+ presenters for each poster, to enable presenters to take turns exploring other posters during their session.
 - If you are planning to be a presenter on multiple posters, please ensure there are enough other presenters because we will not make special accommodations for poster locations (i.e., your posters may be during the same session and are not guaranteed to be next to each other).

Poster Sign-up and Submission

- **Q: How/where do we sign up for our poster?**
 - Work within your teams to determine which projects will be presented.
 - Select a Poster Captain for each poster. The Poster Captain is responsible for ensuring that both the sign-up and final submission are completed accurately and on time. Late submissions will not be accepted.
 - By **September 8th**, Poster Captains should enter the following information into the sign-up spreadsheet located on the Teams site:
 - Sign-Up Sheet: [\[SIGN-UP SHEET LINK\]](#)
 - Poster title (tentative, this can be changed at final poster submission)
 - Poster Captain name
 - Presenter name(s)
- **Q: My poster team has members from different departments. When we sign up, under which functional team do we sign-up?**
 - Please agree on a poster captain and sign up your group under their functional group. It is okay, and encouraged for authors and presenters of the same poster to be from different functional groups and departments, as long as all presenters are in an organization included in the invite list for this event.
- **Q: How/ where do we submit our poster?**
 - Final poster submissions are due **by October 2nd**. Posters must be uploaded to the folder: [Posters Folder | 2026 Innovation Poster Day](#)
 - Please upload your poster to the folder for the department under which you signed up on the sign-up sheet. (Ex., If I am the poster captain, and I am in Sequencing Platforms, I should sign up my poster team in the Sequencing Platforms tab of the signup sheet, under my functional group, and submit my poster to the Sequencing Platforms folder within the Posters Folder).
- **We missed the poster submission deadline, can we still submit?**
 - No, we will not accept late posters. This timing is to allow for printing, mounting, and organizing all posters in time for the event. Each poster captain is responsible for ensuring their team's poster is submitted correctly and on time.

Day-of Event Logistics

Agenda:

Time	Activity
9am – 10am	Keynote Speech (in Seminar A)
10am-10:30am	Attendee Check-in Starts (in CEC)
10:30am - 12:30pm	Poster Session 1
12:30pm – 1:30pm	Lunch
1:30pm – 3:30pm	Poster Session 2
3:30pm – 5pm	Awards & Happy Hour

- **Q: What time should I arrive?**
 - o Innovation Poster Day begins at 9am with a keynote speech in Seminar A. The Customer Excellence Center opens for check-in and poster presentations after the keynote speech finishes at 10am.
- **Q: Do I need to check in?**
 - o Yes, everyone needs to check in prior to viewing any posters in the CEC.
- **Q: How do I know where my poster is?**
 - o Maps will be sent prior to event day, with all location and session (AM or PM) assignments.
- **Q: Do I have to be at my poster the entire event?**
 - o No, you do not need to be at your poster for the entire event. Your poster will be assigned morning or afternoon slot. This information will be shared with the poster map, prior to event day.

For First Time or Newer Poster-Makers

- **Q: Where can I find past posters to use for inspiration?**
 - o A: We do not have archived posters available for everyone to reference, so we recommend you reach out to peers who have presented at past Innovation Days to share their posters with you.
- **Q: Do all poster authors need to be from the same functional group?**
 - o A: No! It is permitted and encouraged to collaborate cross-functionally on posters. Poster authors may be from any group, but poster presenters must

all be from an invited group. The poster captain should sign up their team under their functional team, but all other presenters can be from any team, so long as they are in one of the invited teams (Advanced Science, Sequencing Platforms, Systems Integration and Solutions, Bioinsight, and Experience Design).

- **Q: Is there a poster template?**

- Yes, a template can be found within: [Posters Folder | 2026 Innovation Poster Day](#). Feel free to get creative, but please ensure your poster is 27" x 35" dimensions. Note: quality of posters will not be reviewed by the printing team- please make sure your figures are of high quality.

- **Q: What happens if my file has low-resolution images or printing issues?**

- A: Posters are printed exactly as they are provided, please consider this when adding images and graphs to your poster.

- **Q: Do I need to print or bring a poster? Who handles the poster printing?**

- A: You do not need to print your poster. Poster printing, assembly, and setup are performed by our volunteer team. Your poster will be waiting for you at your assigned location at the start of your presentation session on event day.

- **Q: Are there designated poster presentation times?**

- Yes, your poster will be assigned to a morning or afternoon time slot and location. Please coordinate between presenters to allow for time for everyone to explore other posters during your presentation slot.

- **Q: Can I update my poster after I submit it?**

- Posters can be updated up until the submission deadline on **October 2nd**.

- **Q: Will posters be displayed after Innovation Day?**

- No, posters are disposed of by our volunteer team at the end of Innovation Day for confidentiality reasons.